Social Media Policy

Adopted March 5, 2025

Purpose
The purpose of this policy is to ensure that PVSSD board members and PVFD members who use social media do so in a responsible manner that supports our mission and helps build a trusting relationship with the community.

Procedures
All official PVFD social media sites shall be approved by the Fire Chief or his/her designee.

Social media content shall adhere to applicable laws, regulations and policies, including all information technology and records management policies. Content is subject to public records laws and HIPAA laws.

Personal Use
Members are expected to exercise sound judgment, good common sense, personal responsibility and accountability in social media posts.

Members may not post, transmit, or otherwise disseminate any confidential, sensitive, or potentially sensitive information or pictures to which they have access as a result of their membership in the department or board.

Fire department operations allow access to situations, investigations and scenes that the media and others may not have access to due to operations, safety, or investigative reasons. Any information collected by PVFD members on scene is covered by HIPAA privacy laws and all photos and or videos taken while on scene that contain individually identifiable information should be protected in the same manner.

When appropriate, members should acknowledge opinions expressed are their own and members are not representing PVFD.